

Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) & Computer Graphics (CG)

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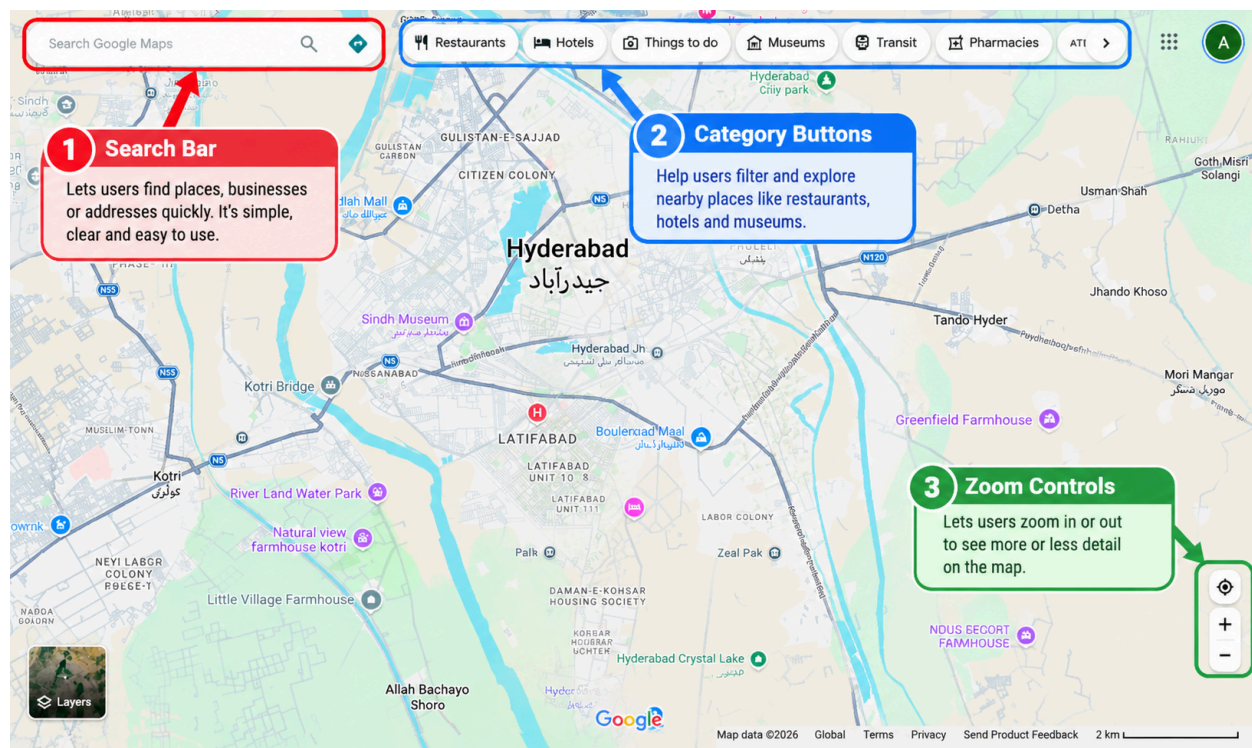
Dept: IMCS

GOOGLE MAPS

HCI Interaction elements

Google Maps is an interactive mapping tool. In 3D/satellite views, users can search, zoom, move and explore locations.

The callouts below show three interface elements and how they support the user.



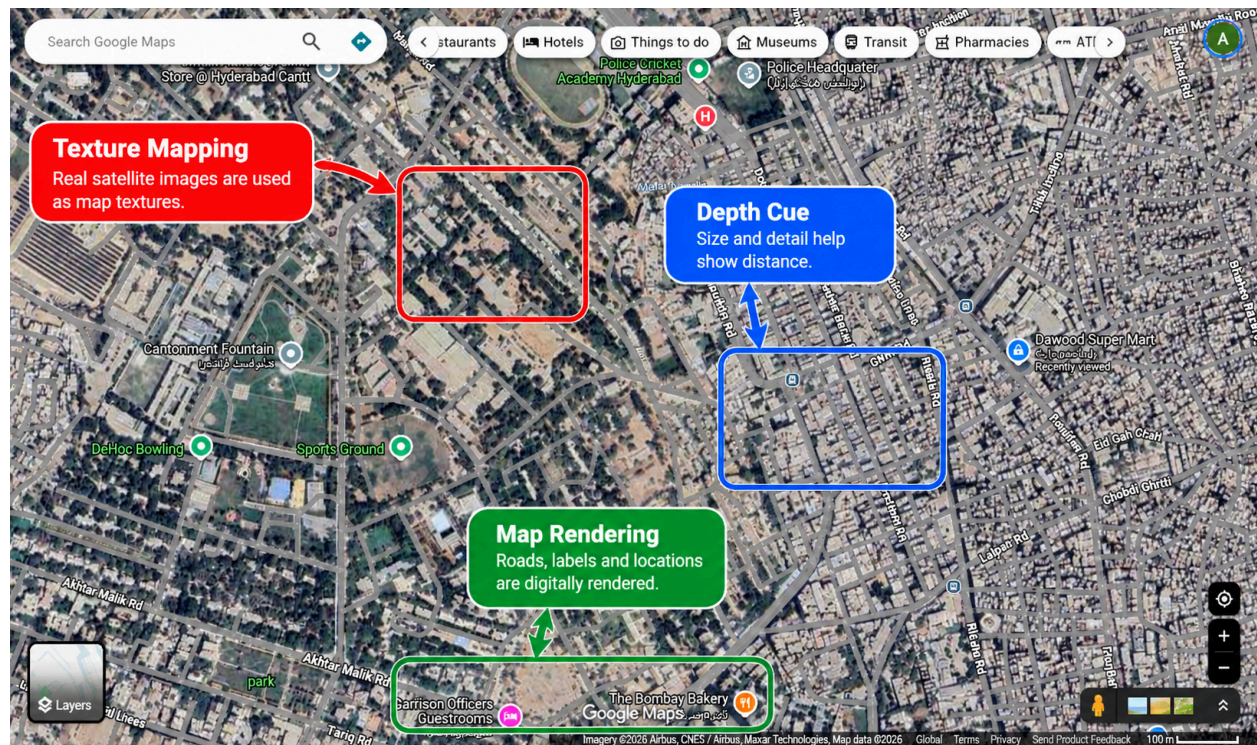
Q. What is one simple HCI change you would make to improve the user interface?

I would make the interface simpler by grouping the most-used buttons together. This would reduce screen clutter and help users find important tools more quickly. Additionally, customizable shortcuts could be introduced so users can pin their frequently accessed features directly to the main screen. Ultimately, these adjustments would streamline navigation and significantly reduce the overall cognitive load for everyday users.

CG rendering/visual elements

The visual quality of **Google Maps** 3D views comes from computer graphics techniques that create depth and realistic space.

Three important visual elements are identified below



Q. How does the Computer Graphics quality (e.g., realistic lighting or 3D view) help or hinder the user's ability to interact with the software?

Good Computer Graphics quality in Google Maps makes the map easier to understand by showing clear roads, locations, and realistic visual details. It helps users recognize places and navigate more easily. Very detailed graphics can sometimes make the application slower on low-performance devices